

About Groundwork Studio

Groundwork Studio AZ LLC is a Phoenix-based web design and digital presence company specializing in clean, fast, hand-coded websites for local service businesses. We build sites from scratch — no templates, no page builders — with custom design, professional copywriting, mobile optimization, and SEO-ready structure built in from day one. Our clients are local businesses (plumbers, HVAC, landscapers, restaurateurs, fitness studios, and more) who need a professional online presence that actually generates calls. Every build is delivered with 50% deposit and 50% on launch. Monthly retainer plans keep sites live, secure, and growing. We operate with a simple, repeatable process that moves from signed agreement to live site in 1–2 weeks.

Service Tiers — What We Build

Every site is built to a tier that sets the baseline page count and price. Tiers are starting points — clients can add or swap pages, and custom configurations are always available.

TIER	BUILD PRICE	PAGES	WHAT'S INCLUDED
T1 Found ation	\$1,000	1 page	Home, Services Overview, Areas We Serve, Contact + Scheduling. Service detail sections built in for every service offered. Custom design, copywriting, mobile optimization, SEO-ready structure, hosting setup.
T2 Standard	\$1,500	1 page	Everything in Tier 1, plus About, Gallery, Reviews, and FAQ sections. Trust signals and social proof for growing businesses.
T3 Elevated	\$2,000	1–7 pages	Everything in Tier 2, plus Financing Page, Specials Page, and Blog. Full-featured build for established businesses. Configuration varies by industry.
T4 Premium	\$2,500	8–11 pages	Everything in Tier 3, plus Online Booking System and Deep SEO Architecture. Maximum local market presence for businesses that want to dominate search.

All tiers are fully customizable. Pages can be added, removed, or swapped across tiers. Custom configurations and exact quotes available on request.

Monthly Retainer Plans

PACKAGE	T1	T2	T3	T4	WHAT THE CLIENT GETS
Maintenance	\$125/mo	\$150/mo	\$175/mo	\$200/mo	Netlify hosting on a global CDN, SSL certificate, uptime monitoring, all security and platform updates, minor content edits on request (up to 1 hr/month), and a monthly uptime report emailed to the client. Rates scale by tier — more pages means more to monitor, maintain, and update each month.
Growth	\$275/mo	\$300/mo	\$350/mo	\$425/mo	Everything in Maintenance, plus active Google Business Profile management: 1–3 GBP posts per month, responses to all new Google reviews, monthly SEO refresh (meta titles and descriptions), monthly keyword ranking report. Higher tiers add proactive review generation strategy, page copy optimization, and quarterly competitor keyword gap analysis.
Local Presence Add-On	\$49/mo + \$99 setup (any tier)	—	—	—	Nextdoor Business page setup and monthly management. Monthly neighborhood post written and published, monitoring for neighbor recommendations and service requests, message responses. Flat rate regardless of tier.

Revenue Math: 10 clients on Maintenance (avg \$150/mo) = **\$1,500/mo** recurring. 5 clients on Growth (avg \$325/mo) = **\$1,625/mo**. The retainer is the real business — every new build adds to a compounding monthly base.

Add-On Services

ADD-ON	PRICE	WHAT THE CLIENT GETS
Logo / Brand Identity	\$300 – \$600	A custom logo and brand kit — color palette, fonts, PNG/SVG/PDF files. Delivered before the site launches so everything matches.
Google Business Profile Setup	\$200 – \$350	Creates or claims and fully optimizes the Google Business listing — the card that appears when someone searches the business name or '[service] near me.' Includes photos, hours, service list, and verification.
SEO Foundation Package	\$400 – \$700	Keyword research for the service area, meta titles and descriptions for every page, schema markup, and XML sitemap submitted to Google Search Console. Price scales with site size.
Booking Integration	\$300 – \$500	Connects Calendly, Square Appointments, or Acuity to the site. Customers book directly without calling. Price reflects integration complexity.

Domain Registration & Setup	\$50 – \$75	We handle domain purchase and full DNS connection — no tech knowledge needed. Clients can also buy their own domain (\$12–\$15/yr) and we connect it at no charge.
Google / Meta Ads Setup	\$400 setup + 10–15%/mo of ad spend	Paid advertising on Google Search and/or Facebook/Instagram targeting the client's service area. Client controls budget — we build and manage campaigns.
Rush Fee	+25% of build fee	Applied when the project must be completed in under 2 weeks. Covers priority scheduling.
Content Delay Fee	\$200 after 14 days	If photos, copy, or logo are not delivered within 14 days of signing, this fee applies and the timeline shifts. Protects the project schedule.
Site Migration (at cancellation)	\$250 one-time	If the client cancels their retainer and wants to move the site to a new host, we package and deliver all site files, assets, and assist with DNS transfer.

ROI Framing by Industry

These figures help contextualize the build investment for clients — one or two jobs typically covers the entire cost of the site.

INDUSTRY	AVG JOB VALUE	JOBS TO COVER BUILD	FRAMING LINE
Plumber	\$600	2 jobs covers a \$1,000–\$1,500 build	"Two service calls pays for the whole site. After that it's free leads."
Landscape r	\$2,500 contract	1 contract covers any tier	"One new landscaping contract pays for the entire website."
HVAC	\$1,500 – \$5,000	1 install covers build + several months retainer	"One HVAC install pays for the site and a year of maintenance."
Auto Repair	\$400 – \$800	2–3 jobs covers T1–T2 build	"Two brake jobs pays for the whole website."
Gym / Fitness	\$150/mo membership	1 member covers retainer monthly	"One new member pays your retainer every month they stay."
Restaurant	\$80/table avg	1 table/week covers hosting	"One table of four covers your hosting for the whole week."

Follow this process for every client, every time.

Stage 1 — Prospecting — Finding Targets

The goal is finding local service businesses with no website, a broken website, or a visibly outdated one. Do not waste time on businesses with polished modern sites — move on immediately.

METHOD	HOW TO USE IT	WHAT YOU'RE LOOKING FOR
leads.py Script (Primary)	Run: <code>python3 leads.py "[industry]" "[city, AZ]" --limit 100</code> Script hits Yelp API, checks each website, outputs CSV with status + pre-written script.	Status = 'none' or 'broken' → HIGH PRIORITY Status = 'has website' → lower priority, manual review
Apple Maps (Supplement)	Search '[industry] near me' — tap each result, look for the website link. No link = no website. Tap the link — does it load?	No website field, site that won't load, site with 'coming soon', site that looks like it's from 2009.
Google Maps (Supplement)	Same as Apple Maps. Also check the 'Website' column when you zoom out on map view — missing website icon is an instant lead.	Businesses with no website button in Google Maps listing.

Target industries: Plumbing · Electrical · HVAC · Roofing · Painting · Pool Service · Landscaping · Auto Repair · Cleaning · Pest Control · Gym/Fitness · Restaurant

Stage 2 — Cold Outreach — First Contact

Primary channel: text message. Secondary: email. Keep messages short, specific to their situation, and end with a soft yes/no question. Never pitch features — pitch the outcome (more calls).

TEXT — No Website

Hey, hope business is going well. Noticed you don't have a website — for a [industry] company, that means homeowners who are ready to book are scrolling past you to someone who does. We build clean, fast sites for local service companies in the Phoenix area, usually live within a week. Take a look at what we do: teamground.work — interested? Evan · Groundwork Studio

TEXT — Broken Website

Hey, hope business is going well. Noticed your website isn't loading properly — for a [industry] company, that's quietly turning away homeowners who are ready to book before they ever reach you. We can get you a clean, working site that starts pulling in new service calls within a couple of weeks — take a look at teamground.work. Interested? Evan · Groundwork Studio

TEXT — Outdated Website

Hey, hope business is going well. Took a look at your site — it has the feel of something built a long time ago and hasn't kept up with the business you're probably running today. Homeowners sizing up a [industry] company will move on quickly if the site doesn't inspire confidence. We build clean, modern sites that have local service companies picking up new clients within a couple of weeks — take a look at [teamground.work](#). Interested? Evan · Groundwork Studio

EMAIL — Subject: Quick question about [Business Name]'s website

Hi [Name], I came across [Business Name] while looking for [industry] companies in the area and noticed [your site isn't loading / you don't have a website yet / your site looks like it could use a refresh]. For a [industry] company, that's likely costing you inbound calls — homeowners decide fast online. I run Groundwork Studio. We build clean, fast websites for local service businesses in Phoenix, usually live within 1–2 weeks. Take a look: [teamground.work](#) Worth a quick chat? Evan Baukol Groundwork Studio (480) 452-6473

Rule: Always personalize the industry word. 'Pool company' not 'service company.' 'HVAC technician' not 'contractor.' The more specific it sounds, the more real it feels.

Stage 3 — Handling Responses

Most responses fall into one of four buckets. Handle each one the same way every time.

RESPONSE TYPE	WHAT THEY SAY	YOUR REPLY	NEXT STEP
Warm Yes	"Yeah sure, what do you offer?"	"Great — can I send you a quick overview, or easier to hop on a 20-minute call?"	Book call → Stage 4
Price Check	"How much does it cost?"	"Depends on what you need — starts at \$1,000. Happy to give you an exact number on a quick call."	Never quote exact price by text. Get them on a call first.
Soft No	"Not right now" / no reply	"Hey, just wanted to circle back — still happy to show you what we'd build for [industry]. Totally free to look."	One follow-up max. If no reply, move on.
Hard No	"Not interested" / "I have someone"	"No problem at all — if anything changes, feel free to reach out."	Log in CSV as 'rejected.' Do not follow up.

Stage 4 — The Sales Call — Closing the Deal

The Secret: You are not selling a website. You are selling more phone calls. The site is just the mechanism. Frame everything around that — always.

30-MINUTE CALL STRUCTURE

PHASE	TIME	WHAT TO DO	GOAL
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1. Shut Up & Ask	0–15 min	Ask discovery questions. Do not pitch. Just listen and take mental notes on the number — what a new customer is worth to them.	Find their pain + their number
2. Reflect It Back	15–17 min	Summarize what they told you in 2 sentences. "So right now people can't find you, and when they do there's no clear way to call you — that's probably costing you a handful of jobs a month."	Make them feel understood
3. Show the Demo	17–22 min	Open teamground.work and pull up their industry demo. "This is the kind of thing we'd build for you." Don't explain how it works. Let them look.	Visual proof without tech talk
4. One Simple Offer	22–27 min	"We build the whole thing for \$1,000 to \$2,500 depending on what you need. Monthly maintenance starts at \$125 — that covers hosting, updates, everything. Most clients are live in two weeks." Then STOP TALKING.	State price then go silent. First to speak loses.
5. Handle & Close	27–30 min	Wait. Then handle the objection and close with: "Want me to send over a simple agreement so we can get started?"	Get a yes or a real objection

DISCOVERY QUESTIONS

QUESTION	WHY YOU'RE ASKING
"How do most of your customers find you right now?"	Reveals if they have any online presence at all.
"When someone finds you online, what do you want them to do?"	Gets them to say 'call me' — which is exactly what a site does for them.
"What does your best customer look like?"	Helps you frame the site around attracting that specific person.
"What's the average job worth to you?"	THE number. Now you can do ROI math with their own figures.
"What would 5 extra jobs a month mean for the business?"	They do the math themselves. Now the site sounds cheap.
"Have you tried getting online before? What happened?"	Surfaces past objections (nephew built it, Wix, etc.) before they become excuses.

OBJECTION HANDLING

OBJECTION	YOUR RESPONSE	NOTES
"That's more than I expected."	"What were you thinking? Let's see if we can work with that."	Drop to T1 (\$1,000) if needed. Keep the monthly. The monthly is what matters long term.

<i>"I need to think about it."</i>	"What's the main thing you're unsure about?"	Never let them leave without surfacing the real objection. 'Think about it' means something specific.
<i>"My nephew can build it."</i>	"Does he do it for other businesses professionally? If something breaks at 11pm, you call us – not him."	Don't trash the nephew. Highlight accountability and reliability.
<i>"I already have a website."</i>	"Can I take a quick look? A lot of sites look fine but aren't actually set up to get calls."	Pull it up on your phone. Find one real issue. Don't pile on — one is enough.
<i>"I can just use Wix."</i>	"You could. Would you do your own plumbing?"	Short. Let it land. Do not over-explain.

Stage 5 — Contract & Deposit — Locking It In

1

Send the contract

Email the filled-out agreement with their project details. Use DocuSign or ask them to print, sign, and photo it back. Either works.

2

Collect the deposit

50% of build fee due before any work starts. Venmo, Zelle, or invoice via Wave. **Do not start without it — no exceptions, ever.**

3

Confirm scope in writing

Reply to their deposit confirmation with a bullet list: exactly what pages are included, how many revision rounds, expected launch date, and content deadline. This protects you if scope creep starts.

4

Content deadline reminder

Tell them: 'I'll need your logo, photos, and any copy by [date 14 days out]. After that a \$200 delay fee kicks in.' Set a calendar reminder for that date.

Stage 6 — Build Process — Getting It Done

1

Set up the project

Create new Netlify project under your team account. Set up the repo (or drop files directly). Connect custom domain immediately — clients love seeing their name in the URL early.

2

Start from the closest industry demo

Pull up teamground.work and reference the closest industry demo. Swap brand colors, logo, photos, and copy. This should take 2–4 hours for a T1 build.

3

Write / edit copy

Use client's notes + their existing content as raw material. Rewrite for clarity and calls-to-action. Every page should end with a phone number or contact form button.

4

Optimize images

Run all photos through Squoosh (squoosh.app, free). Target: under 200KB per image. Slow sites kill conversions.

5

Set up the contact form

Use Netlify Forms: add data-netlify='true' to the form tag + hidden form-name input. Test it — send a real submission and confirm it appears in Netlify dashboard.

6

QA checklist before launch

✓ Mobile looks right on iPhone + Android ✓ All links work ✓ Contact form submits ✓ Images load fast (under 3s on 4G) ✓ No placeholder text left in ✓ Meta title + description set for all pages

Stage 7 — Launch & Handoff

1

Collect final payment

Balance (50%) is due before the site goes live. Invoice the day before launch. **Do not flip the site live until payment clears. No exceptions.**

2

Point the domain

Client buys their domain (GoDaddy, Namecheap). You handle the DNS — add Netlify's nameservers or A/CNAME records. SSL provisions automatically. Usually live within 1 hour.

3

Send the launch message

Text or email: "[Business Name] is live! Here's your site: [url]. Your monthly retainer of \$[X] starts [first of next month]. I'll send a monthly invoice. Reach out any time — I handle everything."

4

Activate monthly retainer

Set up recurring invoice in Wave (free) for retainer amount. First charge on the 1st of the following month. Log client in your retainer tracker.

5

Google Search Console

Add the site to Search Console, submit sitemap, verify with DNS TXT record. Takes 15 minutes. Clients love hearing 'you're now on Google.'

Stage 8 — Monthly Retainer Management

Monthly retainer work is mostly passive. The goal is staying reliable and responsive — that's what keeps clients paying month after month.

PACKAGE	MONTHLY TASKS	TIME REQUIRED
Maintenance	✓ Check for any reported issues ✓ Apply minor text/photo edits if requested (max 1hr) ✓ Verify hosting and SSL are healthy (Netlify auto-renews SSL) ✓ Send monthly 'everything looks good' update email to client	~30–60 min/month
Growth	✓ All Maintenance tasks ✓ Respond to Google reviews within 48hrs ✓ Post 1–3 GBP updates per month ✓ Refresh meta titles/descriptions ✓ Check keyword rankings in Search Console ✓ Send monthly keyword snapshot to client Higher tiers: proactive review generation, copy optimization, quarterly competitor gap analysis.	~1–3 hrs/month
Local Presence Add-On	✓ Post 1 neighborhood update on Nextdoor Business page ✓ Respond to any Nextdoor recommendations or messages ✓ Monitor for mentions or questions	~30 min/month

Stage 9 — Termination & Offboarding

1	30-day notice received Either side can trigger this. Acknowledge in writing: "Got it — your 30-day notice starts today, [date]. Final retainer invoice for [amount] will be sent as usual. The site stays live through [end date]."
2	Collect final payment Invoice the final month's retainer immediately. Do not begin any migration or offboarding until payment clears.
3	Migration (if requested) Client pays \$250 migration fee. Export site files from Netlify as .zip. Hand over all assets (images, logo, copy). Update domain DNS to point to their new host. Collect payment before transferring anything.
4	Take site offline (if no migration) On the termination date, unpublish the site in Netlify. Do not delete the project for 30 days — in case client changes their mind and wants to come back.
5	Leave the door open Send a final message: "Site is now offline. If you ever want to reactivate or rebuild, just reach out — happy to work together again." Referrals and returning clients are common.